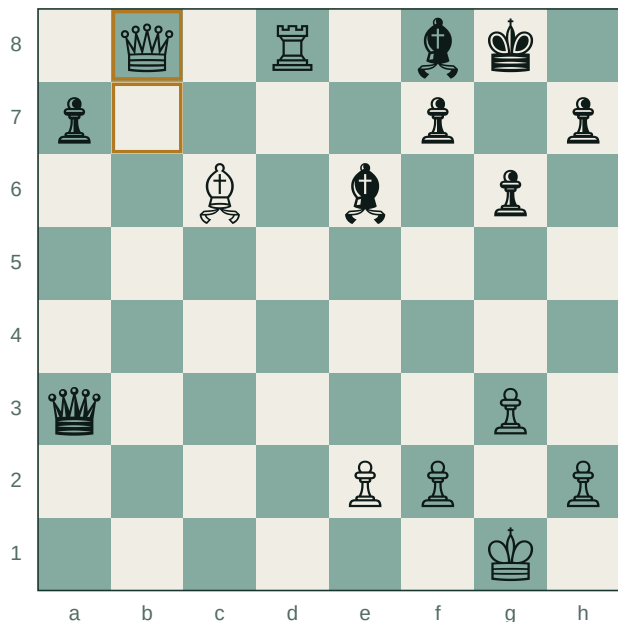


Active defensive resources: Black, move 27

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Qb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Qc1+ 28. Kg2 Qxc6+ 29. f3 Qc5

27...Qc1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From c1 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on c6. Recorded reply: **28.Kg2**.

28...Qxc6+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on c6. Recorded reply: **29.f3**.

29...Qc5 The queen moves from c6 to c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c6. Check for tactical protection.